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Passwords and secure logins, without going crazy

You don't need a champion's memory: you need a few rules and the right tool.

A good password

- At least 12–14 characters long: for example a phrase of four or five random words, such as "horse-pencil-moon-oven".
- Never the same one for two websites, especially your email password.
- No names, dates of birth or sequences like 123456.

The password manager

It's an app that remembers all your passwords for you, protected by a single main password. Free and reliable choices: **Bitwarden** (on computer and phone), **KeePassXC** (on the computer, without the Internet), or the one built into your browser or phone.

Two-step verification

As well as the password you need a code from your phone: even if someone finds out the password, they can't get in. Turn it on first for email, bank and social media.

When you turn it on you are given recovery codes: print them and keep them with your important documents.

Digital ID and codes by text message

- Your digital ID credentials (in Italy SPID, and the PIN of the electronic identity card) are like your house keys: never give them to anyone.
- If someone asks you to read out a code you received by text, or to approve a notification you didn't request, it's a scam.
- If someone is helping you, stay in front of the screen and type the codes yourself.

Updates

Always install updates for the system, the browser and your apps: they close the doors scammers use to get in.

Start with one thing: change your email password and turn on two-step verification. It's the door to all your other accounts.

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